AMANDA HUTCHINSON

arhutch03@yahoo.com

Archival professional who makes municipal and community history findable and teachable. Hands-on experience arranging, describing, cataloging, preserving, and digitizing collections at the City of Savannah Office of Municipal Archives & History, applying DACS and national descriptive standards and maintaining PastPerfect records that give the public online access. Graduate training in archival theory and practice, including appraisal, preservation, and records management, combined with curriculum and program design and customer-focused service gained through teaching and small-business ownership.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Archival and Information Studies
Clayton State University • Expected Graduation December 2026
GPA: 4.0
Relevant coursework: preservation; records management; appraisal and acquisition; reference and access; outreach and advocacy; digital records and access systems

Bachelor of Arts, History
Southern New Hampshire University • Summa Cum Laude

Associate of Science, Dental Assisting with Expanded Functions
Savannah Technical College

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Project Archivist
City of Savannah Office of Municipal Archives & History • October 2026 – Present
Savannah, GA

- Managed PastPerfect records for the archives' collections, which appear on the City's public PastPerfect Online site, supporting discoverability and researcher access.
- Digitized W. W. Law collection materials to improve preservation and public access.
- Processed and arranged a 7-cubic-foot addendum to the Park and Tree Commission Collection, ensuring the records are ready for long-term preservation and researcher access.

Archives Intern
City of Savannah Office of Municipal Archives & History • January 2026 – October 2026
Savannah, GA

- Processed, arranged, and cataloged five distinctive collections significant to Savannah's history, spanning art, religious, civic, and Civil Rights materials: applying DACS and archival best practices while creating finding aids and PastPerfect records to improve discoverability and long-term researcher access.
- Conducted primary-source research to support exhibit curation and outreach initiatives, translating archival materials into public-facing content and contributing archival expertise to a multi-institution community history initiative.
- Designed a series of three classroom lessons on W. W. Law's correspondence in the archives' NAACP collection, teaching students to use letters and postage stamps as primary sources and exploring Law's leadership roles and the history of the mail; each lesson includes Georgia standards, discussion questions, and hands-on activities.
- Authored and published a public history blog series interpreting Savannah's Civil Rights Movement, expanding community engagement with the collection.
- Led digitization efforts, including converting audio cassette tape recordings to digital files and digitizing 19th-century maps. Then cataloged those items into PastPerfect to preserve at-risk materials and broaden public access.

Owner & Photographer
Memorable Moments Photography • 2009 – Present

- Operate an independent photography business, managing client relations, project timelines, and end-to-end production workflows across hundreds of client engagements.

- Organize, tag, and preserve a large-scale digital image archive, applying consistent file-naming conventions, structured metadata, and backup protocols reflective of digital preservation principles.
- Manage long-term digital storage and format migration for photographic assets, mirroring archival practices for ensuring the authenticity, integrity, and continued accessibility of digital collections over time.
- Apply visual literacy and image-evaluation skills developed through professional photography to evaluate, select, and present images for display.
- Cultivate client relationships and translate technical processes for non-technical audiences, strengthening outreach and public-facing communication skills applicable to donor and researcher engagement.

Educator
The Hub for Students • 2022 – 2024
Guyton, GA

- Designed and delivered original curriculum in Georgia History, Roman History, World History, Geography, and Civics for grades First through Twelfth.
- Planned and led experiential field trips connecting classroom instruction to historical sites and primary-source learning, mirroring archives outreach and public programming practice.
- Incorporated primary-source documents and historical artifacts into lessons to build students' research skills and critical-thinking abilities.
- Assessed student progress and adapted instruction to individual learning needs across multi-age classrooms.
- Communicated regularly with families on curriculum goals and student progress, building stakeholder-relations skills transferable to public-facing archival work.

Home Educator
Independent • 2016 – 2024

- Developed and delivered individualized, multi-subject curricula over eight years, building strong organizational, instructional design, and record-keeping skills directly transferable to archival education and outreach work.
- Designed and maintained detailed academic records and learning portfolios, applying organizational and documentation practices consistent with archival record-keeping standards.
- Cultivated student engagement with primary historical sources and independent research projects, fostering early information-literacy skills.
- Independently managed a full multi-year instructional calendar, demonstrating sustained self-direction and program management.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Archival arrangement, processing, and description
- Proper handling procedures for historical objects
- Finding aid creation and collection-level cataloging
- Digitization and digital preservation workflows
- Exhibit curation and public history interpretation
- Project management and program development
- Outreach and donor engagement
- Curriculum design and educational programming
- Archival policy development, including records management and strategic planning

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- DACS (Describing Archives: A Content Standard) Training Certificate, Society of American Archivists, January 2026
- Preservica Academy Certification, August 2025
- Art History Diploma, Centre for Excellence (UK), July 2022
- History of the British Monarchy Diploma, Centre for Excellence (UK), May 2022

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

DACS • LCSH • Dublin Core • Preservica • PastPerfect • Omeka • Archivematica • Audacity • ArchivesSpace • Microsoft Office Suite • Google Workspace • Windows & macOS

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS & SERVICE

- Coastal Museum Association—Member 2026
- Society of Georgia Archivists — Member 2025-Present; Archives Month Committee; Education Committee
- American Historical Society — Member 2023-Present

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Volunteer

Backpack Buddies of Pooler • 2016 – 2025

- Supported a nonprofit ensuring food security for local school children on weekends during the academic year, strengthening teamwork, interpersonal communication, and community-engagement skills.